GAME DESIGNER · HO CHI MINH CITY, VIETNAM

Huynh Thanh Nghi

I design and live-operate mobile F2P games, mainly for the Japanese market. **3 shipped titles, 10M+ combined downloads** — from GDD and level design to gacha economies and post-launch KPI work, with design changes proven in the data.

View shipped titles | Contact | LinkedIn

PLAYER PROFILE
Class: Lead Game Designer / PM

Systems & level design	LV 5+ yrs
Live ops & economy (gacha / IAP)	3 titles
Japanese	JLPT N1
English	TOEIC 970

Shipped Titles 配信タイトル

What I designed, how I decided, and what happened after launch. All free-to-play mobile titles shipped at enish, mainly for the Japanese market.

LAUNCHED 07/2026 · LIVE

Yowamushi Pedal: Resonance Pedaism

弱虫ペダル レゾナンス・ペダイズム — Training sim × bicycle road racing (anime IP)

ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	TEAM
Lead Game Designer · PM	08/2025 – present	90K+ in first month	8 designers (direct) in a 26-person team

44→73% D1 RETENTION AFTER LOOP REDESIGN

7→9–10% D30 AFTER RNG REBALANCE

-2/3 TRAINING CYCLE LENGTH

#1 PAYING-USER RATIO AT ENISH

WHAT I DESIGNED

— Owned the two core features — training simulation and race animation — from benchmark research and GDD to UI wireframes and shipped build.

— Level design linking trained parameters and skills to race outcomes; balanced IAP packs and gacha lineups.

— Built the milestones and the post-launch operation calendar; led the design team through launch into live ops with sprint planning, daily stand-ups and sprint retros.



Store screenshots — training loop, character development, road race

▶ Watch the gameplay video

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

— Specced the training loop as a turn economy: five exercises feed five parameters, while goal, sub-goal and condition all compete for the same limited turns.

— Benchmarked *Uma Musume: Pretty Derby* and *Blue Lock: Project World Champion*, then decided which parameters drive stamina, speed and skill activation in a race. (Mapping under NDA.)

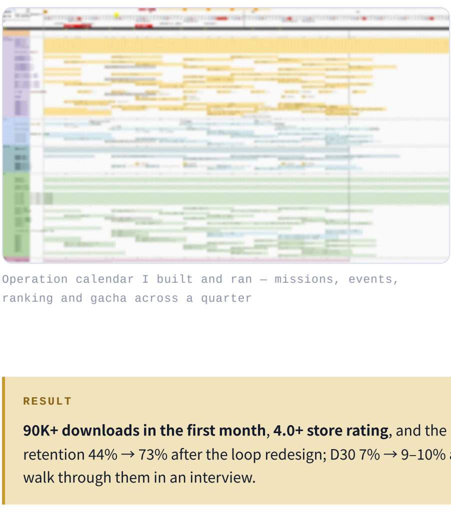
— Built an interaction legend into the wireframe — interactable / non-interactable / special boost — so UI, engineering and art read priority straight off the spec.

— Between test plays: cut the training cycle by two-thirds and retuned goals — players were dropping out before the payoff. Faster to the loop, not easier. **D1 retention rose from 44% to 73%.**

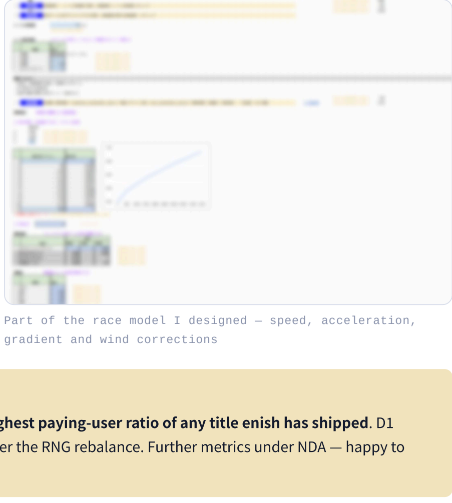
— After launch, D30 sat at 7% against a 10–15% target. Players weren't out of content — late-game RNG made their training and purchases feel meaningless. I rebalanced RNG to matter most in evenly matched races and fade as the power gap grows, backed by win-back campaigns. **D30 rose to 9–10%.**

— Wireframe → final: moved the race button so players stay on training until ready, and merged skill purchase into the skill-point display to cut competing controls.

WIREFRAME → SHIPPED SCREEN

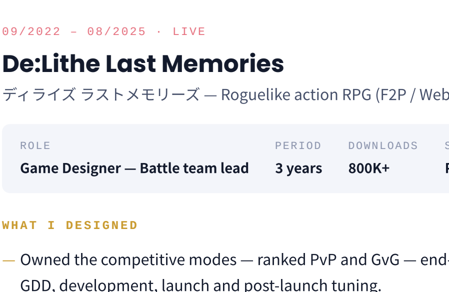


Wireframe I authored — interaction legend built into the spec

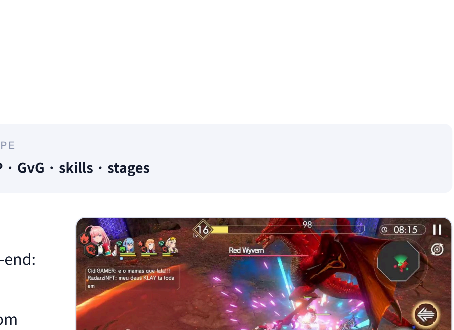


The shipped screen — same hierarchy, IP art layered on top

LIVE-OPS CALENDAR & RACE MODEL — blurred under NDA



Operation calendar I built and ran — missions, events, ranking and gacha across a quarter



Part of the race model I designed — speed, acceleration, gradient and wind corrections

RESULT

90K+ downloads in the first month, **4.0+ store rating**, and the **highest paying-user ratio of any title enish has shipped**. D1 retention 44% → 73% after the loop redesign; D30 7% → 9–10% after the RNG rebalance. Further metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

09/2022 – 08/2025 · LIVE

De:Lithe Last Memories

ディライズ ラストメモリーズ — Roguelike action RPG (F2P / Web3)

ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	SCOPE
Game Designer — Battle team lead	3 years	800K+	PvP · GvG · skills · stages

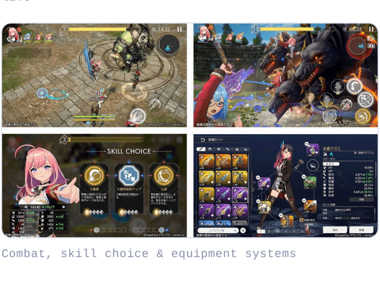
WHAT I DESIGNED

— Owned the competitive modes — ranked PvP and GvG — end-to-end: GDD, development, launch and post-launch tuning.

— Level design for monsters, bosses and stages; character skills from concept to numbers and balancing.

— Tuned battle feel with engineers in the in-house action-command system; directed BGM/SE/voice.

— Shipped every stage, boss and skill on schedule — placing and managing the art, sound and voice orders for each one.



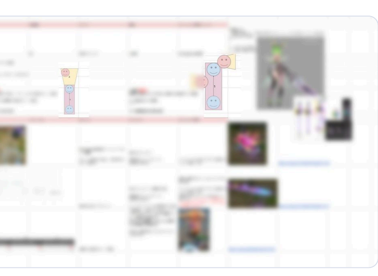
Boss encounter — Red Wyvern raid battle

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

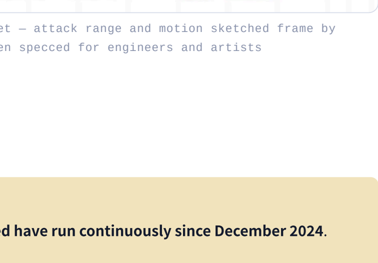
— PvP and GvG were mine from blank page to live season — running continuously since December 2024.

— Designed 60+ stages around them — 32 main-story, 12 daily, a gold-farming stage, plus the two arenas — and the monsters, bosses and skills that fill them.

— Specced battle feel, then tuned it with engineers until the build matched — and directed sound so a skill *reads* as powerful, not just calculates as powerful.

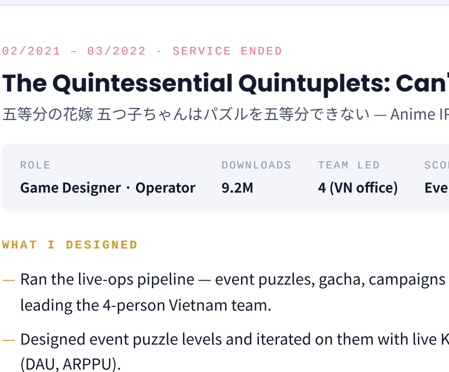


GvG objective battle — feature I owned from GDD to live

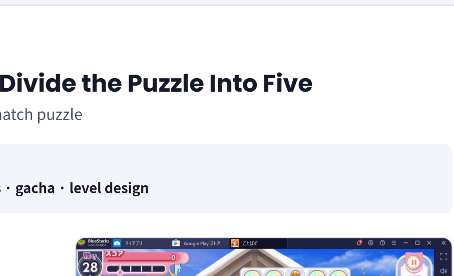


Combat, skill choice & equipment systems

DESIGN DOCUMENTS — text blurred under NDA



Stage design sheet — layout, monster placement and gimmick coverage, with the concept beside each stage



Skill sheet — attack range and motion sketched frame by frame, then specced for engineers and artists

RESULT

800K+ downloads since the June 2024 launch; the **PvP / GvG seasons I owned have run continuously since December 2024**. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

02/2021 – 03/2022 · SERVICE ENDED

The Quintessential Quintuplets: Can't Divide the Puzzle Into Five

五等分の花嫁 五つ子ちゃんはパズルを五等分できない — Anime IP match puzzle

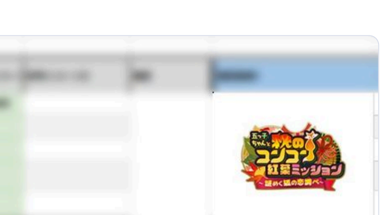
ROLE	DOWNLOADS	TEAM LED	SCOPE
Game Designer · Operator	9.2M	4 (VN office)	Events · gacha · level design

WHAT I DESIGNED

— Ran the live-ops pipeline — event puzzles, gacha, campaigns — leading the 4-person Vietnam team.

— Designed event puzzle levels and iterated on them with live KPI data (DAU, ARPPU).

— Shipped UI/UX improvements from reference to release; wrote official release notes in Japanese.



Event puzzle stage — level design I shipped in live ops

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

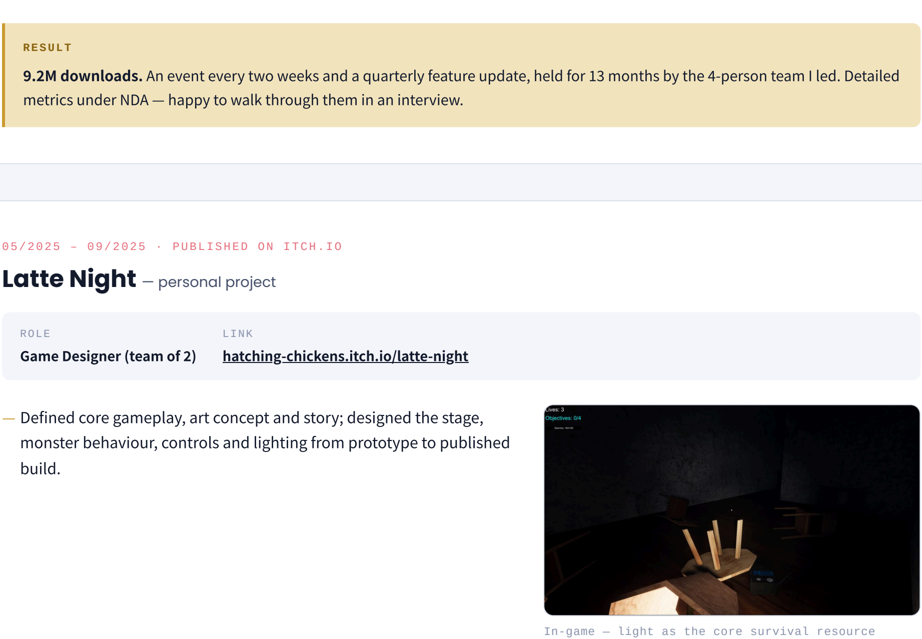
— Held a fixed rhythm for 13 months with no missed release dates: an event every two weeks, a campaign with a new or improved feature every quarter.

— Standardised the pipeline — idea → puzzle set → master data → Japanese release note — and staggered it so two events were always in flight.

— Set difficulty from the previous event's data: clear speed, and how many players finished at all.

— The quarterly slot produced the "Cooking Raiha" idle-cooking system (feature video) — event materials got somewhere to go, so missing an event no longer meant nothing to come back for.

EVENT ASSET ORDER SHEET — text blurred under NDA



One row per asset — brief, reference, approved final. The sheet the JP art side and the VN team worked from every two weeks

RESULT

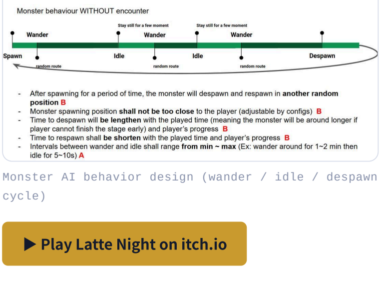
9.2M downloads. An event every two weeks and a quarterly feature update, held for 13 months by the 4-person team I led. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

05/2025 – 09/2025 · PUBLISHED ON ITCH.IO

Latte Night — personal project

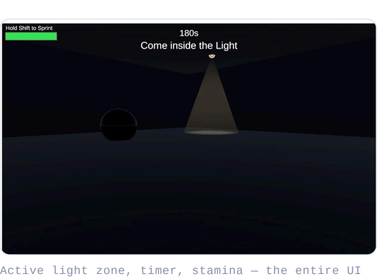
ROLE	LINK
Game Designer (team of 2)	hatching-chickens.itch.io/latte-night

— Defined core gameplay, art concept and story; designed the stage, monster behaviour, controls and lighting from prototype to published build.



In-game — light as the core survival resource

Concept references — story, art, platform & gameplay pillars



Monster AI behavior design (wander / idle / despawn cycle)

▶ Play Latte Night on itch.io

03/2025 · PROTOTYPE

Light Escape — solo 4-hour prototype

ROLE	ENGINE	TIME BOX	ROUND
Solo — design & build	Unity	4 hours	5-minute survival

WHAT I DESIGNED

— Picked the constraint first: one light zone alive at a time, so safety is temporary and the player can never settle. Every other rule serves that one.

— Wrote difficulty as numbers: light cycle 10s → 3s over 180s, ghost 2.5 → 5.5 m/s against a 6.0 sprint, stamina making sprint a spend — early game survivable on reflex, late game only by planning.

— Scoped it to 4 hours solo: one room, no NavMesh, placeholder assets. Choosing what to cut was the exercise.



Active light zone, timer, stamina — the entire UI the game needs

Art Quality & IP 品質基準

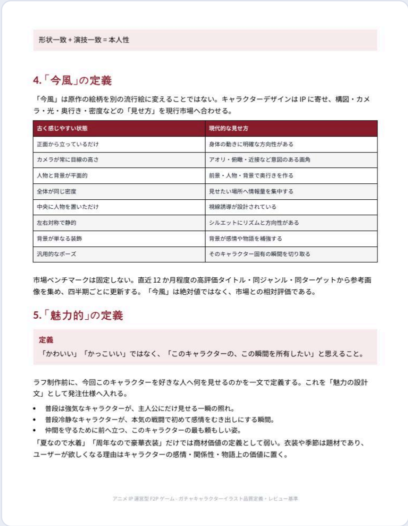
"Doesn't look like them." "Old-fashioned." "Not attractive." — vague feedback on gacha art stalls production. I wrote a review standard that turns it into criteria artists and the IP holder can check at rough stage.

— **Four gates, not a score:** identity (it's really them), character (it's like them), ownership ("I want this one"), modern appeal (holds up next to today's top gacha). A card passes only when all four do.

— **Taste made checkable:** "similar" becomes face, silhouette, expression and posture; "modern" becomes camera, light and depth against a benchmark set refreshed each quarter.

— **"Attractive" made a spec:** each art order carries one sentence defining the moment fans will want to own.

— Agreed with the IP holder over several meetings, so approvals stopped blocking releases.



アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム
ガチャキャラクターイラスト 品質定義・レビュー基準

ラフ段階で「似ている・今風・魅力的」を判定するための実務ガイド

目的
感覚的なフィードバックである「似てない」「古臭い」「魅力的じゃない」を、制作前とラフ段階で判定できる評価基準へ変換する。

1. 結論

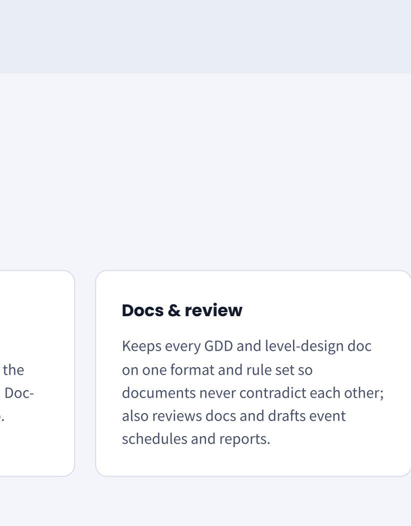
定義
原作ファンが一目で「本人だ」と認識でき、そのキャラクターらしい新しい魅力を感じ、「この一枚を手に入れたい」と思える、現在の市場水準に達した商品ビジュアル。

品質は「本人性」「キャラクター性」「所有欲」「現代的商品性」の４軸で評価する。

軸	定義	ユーザーの反応
本人性	原作のキャラクター本人に見える	「〇〇だ」
キャラクター性	性格・関係性・世界観に合っている	「〇〇らしい」
所有欲	普段とは違う価値のある瞬間になっている	「これ欲しい」
現代的商品性	現在の高品質ガチャと並べても見劣りしない	「豪華」「新しい」

アニメIP運営型F2Pゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レビュー基準

The standard (Japanese) — definition and four evaluation axes



形状一致＋演技一致＝本人性

4.「今風」の定義
「今風」は原作の絵柄を別の流行絵に変えることではない。キャラクターデザインはIPに寄せ、構図・カメラ・光・奥行き・密度などの「見せ方」を現行市場へ合わせる。

古く感じやすい状態	現代的な見せ方
正面から立っているだけ	身体の動きに明確な方向性がある
カメラが常に目線の高さ	アオリ・俯瞰・近接など意図のある画角
人物と背景が平面的	前景・人物・背景で奥行きを作る
全体が同じ密度	見せたい場所へ情報量を集中する
中央に人物を置いただけ	視線誘導が設計されている
左右対称で静的	シルエットにリズムと方向性がある
背景が単なる説明	背景が感情や物語を補強する
汎用的なポーズ	そのキャラクター固有の瞬間を切り取る

市場ベンチマークは固定しない。直近12か月程度の高評価タイトル・同ジャンル・同ターゲットから参考画像を集め、四半期ごとに更新する。「今風」は絶対値ではなく、市場との相対評価である。

5.「魅力的」の定義

定義
「かわいい」「かっこいい」ではなく、「このキャラクターの、この瞬間を所有したい」と思えること。

ラフ制作前に、今回このキャラクターを好きな人へ何を見せるのかを一文で定義する。これを「魅力の設計文」として発注仕様へ入れる。
- 普段は強気なキャラクターが、主人公にだけ見せる一瞬の照れ。
- 普段冷静なキャラクターが、本気の戦闘で初めて感情をむき出しにする瞬間。
- 仲間を守るために前へ立つ、このキャラクターの最も頼もしい姿。

「夏なので水着」「周年なので豪華衣装」だけでは商材価値の定義として弱い。衣装や季節は題材であり、ユーザーが欲しくなる理由はキャラクターの感情・関係性・物語上の価値に置く。

アニメIP運営型F2Pゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レビュー基準

Old-fashioned vs. modern presentation — taste turned into a checklist

AI Tools I Built AI活用

Agents that take the repetitive work off designers and QA.

Daily bug-check
Scans master data and code against the operation schedule every day. QA's routine check dropped to **under 10 minutes a day**.

Master-data entry
Reads level-design docs — rates, rewards, quantities — and enters the data itself. Designers only review. Doc-to-data mismatches went to **zero**.

Docs & review
Keeps every GDD and level-design doc on one format and rule set so documents never contradict each other; also reviews docs and drafts event schedules and reports.

What I Can Do For You お手伝いできること

Available for full-time roles and freelance engagements.

Feature & systems design
GDD authoring, benchmark research, UI wireframes, and follow-through with engineering and art until the feature ships.

Live ops & economy
Event and gacha planning, IAP pack design, operation calendars, and KPI-driven iteration (DAU, ARPPU, retention).

JP ↔ VN / EN bridge
Trilingual design communication, spec translation, meeting interpretation, and cross-cultural team coordination — JLPT N1, TOEIC 970.

About 自己紹介

I came to games from an unusual road — a Japanese Law degree, then language school in Japan. Law taught me to read dense material closely, find the rule underneath it, and argue from evidence rather than instinct — the same muscle behind benchmark research, GDD writing, and reading KPI data before touching a number.

Every genre I've shipped in — match puzzle, action RPG, training sim — I learned from zero. Breaking an unfamiliar domain down and turning it into a spec other people can build from is what I do fastest. Japanese, Vietnamese and English are how I gather that information, not the whole of what I bring.

Five years at enish took me from operating events on a 9.2M-download puzzle game to leading the design team of a new IP title through launch. I build AI tools for my teams — a bug-check agent that cut routine QA to under 10 minutes a day, a master-data agent with zero entry mismatches — because how fast a team iterates matters as much as what it ships.

I play widely, too — 348 hours in *Umamusume: Pretty Derby*, plus *Blue Lock: Project World Champion*, *Dark War Survival*, *Arena of Valor*, *Cult of the Lamb*, *Sea of Stars*, *Little Nightmares*, *God of War*, *The Last of Us* and *Horizon*.

Long-term goal: to be a game producer, and to ship a game the world knows as **made in Vietnam, led by a woman**.

Languages & Recognition

Japanese	JLPT N1 · J-Test 707
English	TOEIC 970 · IELTS 7.0
Vietnamese	Native
Best Employee of the Year, enish Vietnam	×3 consecutive
Japan Foundation young researchers program	2018

Let's make something players remember.

Open to Game Designer / Lead Game Designer roles and freelance projects.

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